# HERALDRY SKIRMISH

## THE DYING LANDS

*A competitive GM-less PvPvE fantasy tabletop miniature skirmish game*

PRODUCTION SPECIMEN ? representative pages extracted from the RC484 build for design review. Not the finished book.

**Release Candidate 484 (RC484)**

2.

# Core Mechanics

Heraldry Skirmish uses fixed procedures for uncertainty, movement, visibility, terrain, and resource spending. Uncertain actions use a **Check** against **12**. Unless a rule says otherwise, this section applies to every mode of play.

## 2.1 Core Terms

A **combatant** is any Hero, Hireling, Monster, Summon, or other model that can act on the battlefield.

A **Hero** is a player-controlled adventurer and the primary member of a party.

A **Hireling** is an allied non-Hero combatant whose profile or granting rule identifies them as a Hireling. Hirelings follow the normal rules for combatants unless a rule says otherwise.

A **Monster** is a neutral or hostile non-party combatant controlled by the Monster AI rules.

A **Summon** is a temporary combatant that their creating rule identifies as a Summon. A combatant does not become a Summon merely because a rule places or creates them. In particular, a named bestiary Monster placed by a Monster or scenario rule remains a **Monster** unless that rule explicitly identifies them as a Summon.

A **living combatant** is any combatant that does not have the **Undead** or **Construct** ability.

A **Celestial** is a combatant whose rule gives them the **Celestial** tag. A **Fiend** is a combatant whose rule gives them the **Fiend** tag; the **Fiend** Special Ability grants this tag. Neither tag has an effect by itself; rules that affect Celestials or Fiends say so explicitly.

An **allied** combatant is on your side. An **ally** is another combatant on your side; you are not your own ally. A rule that can affect you says **you**, **yourself**, **self**, or **you or an ally**. An **enemy** combatant is any combatant not on your side, including opposing party combatants and Monsters, unless a rule says a specific combatant is not an enemy for that interaction.

A **party** is one side's allied Heroes and Hirelings. Allied Summons belong to their controlling party for party-wide limits, but are not Heroes, Hirelings, or Roster members.

A **Party Leader** is the Hero designated by a side to anchor that side's Initiative rolls and to make choices assigned to the **Party Leader** by these rules. Each side designates one **Party Leader** as described in **6.1**. A party does not replace its **Party Leader** during an adventure. If the **Party Leader** is not on the battlefield, use **3.2** for Initiative and **6.1** for shared-control authority.

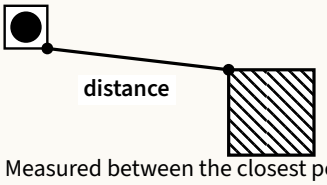
A **target** is the combatant, marker, hazard, terrain feature, or point chosen by a rule or action.

A combatant, marker, hazard, terrain feature, or point is **adjacent** to another when the horizontal distance and vertical separation between the two are each **1"** or less. In **Grid Mode**, the two horizontal positions must overlap or neighbour each other orthogonally or diagonally, and the vertical separation between them must be **1"** or less.

A **space** is the area a combatant, marker, hazard, or terrain feature occupies. A combatant's space is their rules **footprint**, determined by **Sz** under the **Size and Footprints** rules in **2.6**. In **Grid Mode**, it is the square or squares that footprint occupies.

Unless a rule says otherwise, combatants are aware in all directions and do not use facing.

**A** **Tabletop Mode (2.6)**

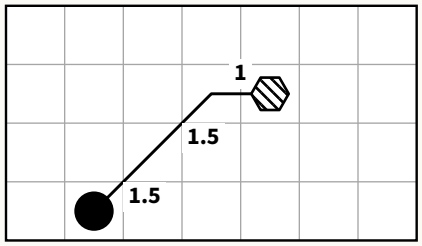



Measured between the closest points of the source and target spaces.

Rules footprints are used, not the miniature's base. Rules that measure from a point use that point.

**Schematic — not to scale**

**B** **Grid Mode: range / distance (2.6)**

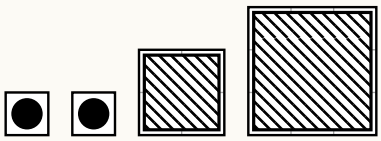



source square

**1.5" + 1.5" + 1" = 4"**

Orthogonal square = 1", diagonal square = 1.5". Count the shortest grid distance without the source square. Obstacles do not change it; check LOS, Cover and terrain separately.

**C** **Grid Mode: footprints (2.6)**




A combatant occupies the squares of their Sz footprint (S and M 1×1, L 2×2, H 3×3). Their whole footprint must fit in every legal final position.

**D** **Declared movement and positional state (2.6.1)**

**1 Declare**
Before voluntary or forced movement, declare the intended path and final position (for placement, the final position).

→

**2 Verify**
An opposing player may measure and verify it. If illegal, amend it or choose another action; an abandoned declaration costs no AP.

→

**3 Move**
Once movement begins, or a Reaction is declared against it, the declaration cannot be amended or abandoned. A triggered Reaction resolves at the first point on the path where its trigger occurs.

→

**4 Declared State**
The actual path and final position become the Declared State until the combatant moves or is moved. If a miniature is moved accidentally, restore it.

**FIG-04.** Tabletop Mode measures between closest points; Grid Mode counts orthogonal squares as 1" and diagonal squares as 1.5", so this range is 1.5 + 1.5 + 1 = 4" without the source square. Footprints follow Sz, and movement is declared and verified before it is resolved (see 2.6).

Track movement and distance in **0.5"** increments. Do not round a **1.5"** diagonal or a combatant's remaining movement.

If a source or target occupies more than one square, check each source-square and target-square pair. When range, **LOS**, and **Cover** apply to the same target or effect, one pair must satisfy all requirements. If more than one pair does, use the pair that grants the target the least **Cover**. If **Cover** is tied, use the shortest range. For a distance that does not also require **LOS** or **Cover**, use the closest occupied squares.

If a rule measures from or to a point, marker, hazard, or terrain feature, use the square containing it unless the rule says otherwise.

**Universal Rounding:** Do not round measured distances, listed fractional distances, or Grid Mode movement tracked in **0.5"** increments. When any other calculation in Heraldry Skirmish produces a fraction, round down to the nearest whole number immediately after that calculation. Rounding down is the default and need not be restated. A rule that requires a different direction must say so explicitly using the phrase **rounded up**.

**Minimum Values:** Except for ability scores, values cannot be reduced below **0** unless a rule explicitly says otherwise.

## Size and Footprints

Every combatant has a **Size (Sz): Small (S), Medium (M), Large (L),** or **Huge (H)**. Published profiles list **Sz** explicitly. If a temporary or generic combatant has no listed Size, treat them as **Medium (Sz M)**.

| Sz | Size | Footprint | Grid Footprint |
|---|---|---|---|
| **S** | Small | **1"×1"** | **1×1 square** |
| **M** | Medium | **1"×1"** | **1×1 square** |
| **L** | Large | **2"×2"** | **2×2 squares** |

3.

# The Game Round

Heraldry Skirmish is played in rounds. Each round has four phases: **Initiative Phase**, **Party Phase**, **Monster Phase**, and **End of Round**.

## 3.1 Overview of a Round

Unless a specific rule changes the order of the **Party Phase** and **Monster Phase**, each round is resolved in the following order:

**Initiative Phase**

- Refresh AP for each combatant on the battlefield with an AP maximum.
- Determine Initiative.
- Resolve start-of-round effects.

**Party Phase**

- Sides alternate activating eligible allied combatants.
- Heroes, Hirelings, and allied Summons act during this phase unless a rule says otherwise.
- Each allied combatant may activate **once per round** while they are eligible.

**Monster Phase**

- Resolve Monster waking rules.
- Activate each **Awake** Monster Group.

**End of Round**

- Resolve end-of-round effects.
- End effects that last **until the end of the round**.
- Remove unspent AP.
- Resolve scenario scoring, extraction, round limits, and victory conditions.

A new round begins after the previous round ends unless the scenario ends first.

If a specific rule places the **Monster Phase** before the **Party Phase**, both phases still resolve once before the **End of Round** begins.

Place the combatant at a legal destination, or a legal destination square in **Grid Mode**, within the listed distance and any listed **LOS** requirement. The destination must have enough legal space for the combatant's footprint and a surface that could normally support them. A combatant cannot teleport into empty air unless they can fly or a rule explicitly allows it. Apply terrain, hazards, **Light**, **Darkness**, **Cover**, and other destination effects after placement.

### 4.4.6 Forced Movement

**Forced movement** is movement caused by a rule rather than chosen by the moved combatant. Forced movement never triggers **Reflex Attack**.

**Push X"** moves the target up to **X"** directly away from the source of the effect or directly away from a specified point.

**Pull X"** moves the target up to **X"** directly toward the source of the effect or directly toward a specified point.

**Slide X"** moves the target up to **X"** in the direction named by the effect.

In **Tabletop Mode**, determine the direction of a **Push** or **Pull** using the straight line between the centres of the source's and target's spaces, or between the specified point and the centre of the target's space. If the centres coincide, the controller of the effect chooses the direction.

In **Grid Mode**, each square of **Push** must increase the target's grid distance from the source or specified point. Each square of **Pull** must decrease that distance. If more than one legal square qualifies, the controller of the effect chooses. **Slide** follows the direction named by the effect; if more than one legal square matches that direction, the controller of the effect chooses.

Forced movement cannot move a target through **Impassable Terrain** or **Blocking Terrain**, through another combatant, or into an illegal position unless the rule explicitly allows it. Move the target as far along the forced movement path as possible and stop them at the last legal position.

If **Impassable Terrain**, **Blocking Terrain**, or another combatant causes the target to stop early, the target suffers a **Collision**. A stop caused only by another restriction is not a **Collision**. A **Collision** deals no damage by itself; a rule that deals **Collision** damage says so.

A battlefield edge stops movement unless a scenario allows that combatant to leave through it during voluntary movement or the rule causing the movement explicitly allows them to leave. Stopping at a battlefield edge is not a **Collision** or **Falling** unless a rule identifies that edge as a physical obstacle or drop.

A missing supporting surface beyond an edge, including a chasm or pit assigned **Impassable Terrain**, does not stop forced movement. If forced movement would carry a target beyond that edge, move them to the edge point along the forced movement path, then resolve **Falling** from that point after the forced movement ends. This is not a **Collision**.

If forced movement moves a target into hazardous terrain or another rule-defined danger, resolve that hazard after the forced movement ends.

> *Example: An effect pushes a Skeleton 3" directly away from the effect's source, toward a ledge that lies 2" along the forced movement path. The missing surface beyond the ledge does not stop the forced movement. The Skeleton moves 2" to the edge point, the forced movement ends, and the Skeleton then resolves **Falling** from that point.*

| d20 | Background |
|---|---|
| 12 | Alchemist |
| 13 | Believer |
| 14 | Hermit |
| 15 | Cultist |
| 16 | Shepherd |
| 17 | Merchant |
| 18 | Noble |
| 19 | Pauper |
| 20 | Vagabond |

## Farmer

*A farmer grows up with callused hands, stubborn habits, and the certain knowledge that work hurts and stops for no one. Hard ground built them a thicker frame than most wandering blades will ever earn.*

**Bonus: +1 STR**
**Starting Coins and Items:** 1c, Sickle, Bandages
**Special Rule:** Gain **+3 Max HP**.

## Nomad

*A nomad crosses hard country under open skies, surviving where the roads fail and shelter is never promised. The land that grinds others down only taught them its lessons.*

**Bonus: +1 STR**
**Starting Coins and Items:** 1c, Scimitar
**Special Rule:** Once per round, when terrain, weather, or a scenario hazard would cause this Hero to suffer damage or HP loss, reduce that damage or HP loss by **1**.

## Sailor

*A sailor learns balance on wet planks and danger under bad skies, shaped by rope, spray, and labour that does not wait on the weather. They keep their feet and keep moving while steadier folk go down.*

**Bonus: +1 STR**
**Starting Coins and Items:** 1c, Rope, Shortsword, Buckler
**Special Rule:** Ignore additional movement costs and movement **Checks** caused by wind, rain, ice, shallow water, and **Slippery Terrain** caused by water, ice, or weather. Your **Checks** to resist forced movement caused by wind or water are rolled with **Advantage**.

## Soldier

*A soldier marched where they were told and fought when they were ordered, and learned that discipline keeps people alive longer than courage alone. War has settled into them now, and sits easy on the shoulders.*

**Bonus: +1 STR**
**Starting Coins and Items:** 1c, Spear
**Special Rule:** Your first melee attack each round deals an additional **1 damage of that attack's primary damage type**.

## Smuggler

*A smuggler lives by false bottoms, whispered routes, and the craft of keeping valuable things out of dangerous hands. Stealth is not a flourish to them. It is the trade that buys supper.*

**Bonus: +1 DEX**
**Starting Coins and Items:** 1c, Dagger, Lockpicks
**Special Rule:** While you are in **Cover**, your **Hide distance** is **0"**.

## Courier

*A courier carried news, coin, or secrets across broken roads and worse weather, for patrons who paid for speed and asked no questions. Speed was never a convenience. It was the difference between arriving and being found later.*

**Bonus: +1 DEX**
**Starting Coins and Items:** 1c, Shortbow
**Special Rule:** Gain **+1" SPD**.

## Scout

*A scout lived ahead of the line, where a broken branch or a fresh print decided whether the column ate or buried. They read ground, distance, and silence better than most people read letters.*

**Bonus: +1 DEX**
**Starting Coins and Items:** 1c, Shortbow
**Special Rule:** During each **Move**, ignore the first **1"** of additional movement cost imposed by **Difficult Terrain**.

## Performer

*A performer survived on wit, nerve, and the knack of making a crowd look where they wanted. Stage,*

## 7.8 Melee Weapons

*Many of the arms below carry names from an older, wider world than the Bastions now remember: the long-bladed messer, the notched sword-breaker, the throwing cross, the bladed scourge, the weighted cord, and the hook-and-chain. They reach the Dying Lands as salvage, tribute, and trade goods, carried up the southern routes through Saltspire and bartered onward through Reedmarch. How a blade is named changes nothing about how it cuts. Each is listed here under the name the traders used.*

**Unarmed Combat** is a universal attack profile, not an item. A Hero may use it only while both hands are free. It cannot be bought, sold, carried, lost, disarmed, or enhanced unless a rule explicitly says otherwise.

Damage type abbreviations in weapon tables: **(B)** blunt, **(P)** piercing, **(S)** slashing, **(F)** fire, **(I)** ice, **(L)** lightning, **(N)** necrotic, **(H)** holy, **(Ar)** arcane, **(Po)** poison, **(Ps)** psychic.

| Weapon | Cost (c) | Hands | STR Req | DEX Req | Damage | Traits |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Unarmed Combat | 0 | 2 | - | - | 1 (B) | **Trip** |
| Club | 0 | 1 | - | - | 1d4 (B) | - |
| Mace | 2 | 1 | 2 | - | 1d6 (B) | **Parrying** |
| Morningstar | 6 | 1 | 2 | - | 1d8 (B) | **Deadly** |
| Flail | 10 | 1 | 3 | - | 1d8 (B) | **Sweep**, **Trip** |
| War Maul | 24 | 2 | 4 | - | 1d12 (B) | **Fatal**, **Heavy** |
| Greathammer | 30 | 2 | 5 | - | 1d12+1 (B) | **Fatal**, **Heavy** |
| Dagger | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1d4 (P) | **Agile**, **Finesse**, **Light** |
| Stiletto | 2 | 1 | 1 | 2 | 1d4 (P) | **Deadly**, **Finesse**, **Light** |
| Shortsword | 5 | 1 | 2 | 1 | 1d6 (S) | **Light**, **Parrying** |
| Rapier | 8 | 1 | - | 3 | 1d8 (P) | **Agile**, **Finesse**, **Parrying** |
| Estoc | 19 | 1/2 | 3 | 2 | 1d8/1d10 (P) | **Fatal**, **Finesse**, **Versatile** |
| Baselard | 6 | 1 | 2 | 2 | 1d6 (S) | **Agile**, **Light**, **Parrying** |
| Sabre | 8 | 1 | 2 | 4 | 1d8 (S) | **Agile**, **Finesse**, **Light**, **Parrying** |
| Scimitar | 7 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 1d8 (S) | **Agile**, **Finesse**, **Graze** |
| Longsword | 12 | 1/2 | 3 | - | 1d8/1d10 (S) | **Parrying**, **Versatile** |
| Bastard Sword | 30 | 1/2 | 4 | - | 1d10/1d12 (S) | **Parrying**, **Versatile** |
| Langes Messer | 19 | 1/2 | 3 | 2 | 1d8/1d10 (S) | **Deadly**, **Parrying**, **Versatile** |
| Great Falchion | 8 | 2 | 3 | 1 | 1d10 (S) | **Graze**, **Sweep** |
| Flamberge | 42 | 2 | 5 | - | 1d12+1 (S) | **Deadly**, **Graze**, **Heavy**, **Parrying** |
| Zweihander | 48 | 2 | 6 | 1 | 1d12+2 (S) | **Cleave**, **Fatal**, **Heavy** |
| Claymore | 24 | 2 | 5 | - | 1d12 (S) | **Cleave**, **Graze**, **Heavy** |
| Battleaxe | 18 | 1/2 | 3 | - | 1d8/1d10 (S) | **Cleave**, **Parrying**, **Versatile** |
| Greataxe | 36 | 2 | 4 | - | 1d12+1 (S) | **Cleave**, **Fatal**, **Heavy** |
| Handaxe | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1d6 (S) | **Light**, **Thrown** |
| Throwing Cross | 5 | 1 | - | 4 | 1d6 (S) | **Agile**, **Deadly**, **Thrown** |
| Billhook | 6 | 1 | 1 | 2 | 1d6 (S) | **Agile**, **Light**, **Trip** |
| War Pick | 6 | 1 | 2 | - | 1d8 (P) | **Fatal**, **Parrying** |
| Glaive | 10 | 2 | 3 | 1 | 1d10 (S) | **Graze**, **Reach**, **Sweep** |

Description: You are **Resistant** to **lightning** and **arcane**. You cannot become **Silenced**, and Powers cannot **Push**, **Pull**, or **Slide** you.

**4 Nightshroud Armour**
Equipment Type Chest AD/AV d12+2 STR - DEX 7 INT 4 SPI - DEX Pen -2 Max Speed 8" Cost (c) 120
Description: While you are in **Darkness**, your **Hide distance** is **0"**. While you are in **Darkness**, gain **+2 AV**. When you take the **Shift** action while in **Darkness**, you may **Shift 2"** instead of **1"**.

**5 Saint's Chain of Glory**
Equipment Type Chest AD/AV d12+5 STR 7 DEX - INT - SPI 4 DEX Pen -5 Max Speed 5" Cost (c) 130
Description: You are **Resistant** to **holy**. You cannot become **Cursed**. The first time each round an **Undead** or **Fiend** would damage you, reduce that damage to **0**.

**6 Archsage Vestments**
Equipment Type Chest AD/AV d12+2 STR - DEX 7 INT 4 SPI - DEX Pen -2 Max Speed 8" Cost (c) 124
Description: Gain **+2** to **Casting Checks**, are **Resistant** to damage from Powers, and gain **+2** on **Checks** made to resist enemy Powers.

**7 Adamant Sentinel Plate**
Equipment Type Chest AD/AV d12+5 STR 8 DEX - INT - SPI - DEX Pen -5 Max Speed 5" Cost (c) 132
Description: You are **Resistant** to **blunt**. Attacks against you cannot deal **Critical Hit** bonus damage or trigger **Critical Hit** effects.

**8 Hawkflight Harness**
Equipment Type Chest AD/AV d12+2 STR - DEX 7 INT - SPI 4 DEX Pen -2 Max Speed 8" Cost (c) 120
Description: Gain **Fly (12")** and become **Immune** to **Prone**.

**9 Dragonlord Bulwark**
Equipment Type Hands AD/AV +6 STR 8 DEX - INT - SPI - DEX Pen -5 Max Speed 5" Cost (c) 120
Description: While using **Block**, you are **Resistant** to **fire**, **ice**, and **acid**.

**10 Glory Aegis**
Equipment Type Hands AD/AV +6 STR 7 DEX - INT - SPI 4 DEX Pen -4 Max Speed 5" Cost (c) 120
Description: While using **Block**, you are **Resistant** to **holy**.

**11 Stormkeeper's Wall**
Equipment Type Hands AD/AV +6 STR 8 DEX - INT - SPI - DEX Pen -5 Max Speed 5" Cost (c) 120
Description: While using **Block**, you are **Resistant** to **lightning** and **arcane**.

**12 Cloak of Infinite Night**
Equipment Type Back AD/AV +1 STR - DEX 7 INT 4 SPI - DEX Pen - Max Speed - Cost (c) 116
Description: Gain **+1 AV**. While you are in **Darkness**, your **Hide distance** is **0"**, and nonadjacent enemies cannot remove your **Hidden** with **Spot**.

**13 Adamantine Wall**
Equipment Type Hands AD/AV +6 STR 8 DEX - INT - SPI - DEX Pen -5 Max Speed 5" Cost (c) 126
Description: While using **Block**, attacks cannot deal **Critical Hit** bonus damage or trigger **Critical Hit** effects against you.

**14 Sacred Bulwark of Saints**
Equipment Type Hands AD/AV +6 STR 7 DEX - INT - SPI 4 DEX Pen -4 Max Speed 5" Cost (c) 122
Description: While using **Block**, you are **Resistant** to damage from attacks, Powers, and Special Abilities made by Undead, Fiends, and **Cursed** combatants. You have **Advantage** on **Checks** made to resist their Powers, Special Abilities, and negative conditions.

**15 Mantle of the Phoenix**
Equipment Type Back AD/AV +1 STR - DEX 7 INT - SPI 4 DEX Pen - Max Speed - Cost (c) 116
Description: Gain **+1 AV**. You are **Resistant** to **fire**. At the end of each round, restore 1 HP.

**16 Cloak of Infernal Embers**
Equipment Type Back AD/AV +1 STR - DEX 7 INT - SPI 4 DEX Pen - Max Speed - Cost (c) 118
Description: Gain **+1 AV**. After a non-**Total Miss** melee attack against you resolves, the attacker suffers **4 fire damage**.

**17 Frostcloak of Immortals**
Equipment Type Back AD/AV +1 STR - DEX 7 INT - SPI 4 DEX Pen - Max Speed - Cost (c) 118
Description: Gain **+1 AV**. After a non-**Total Miss** melee attack against you resolves, the attacker suffers **4 ice damage**.

**18 Mantle of the Stormlord**
Equipment Type Back AD/AV +1 STR - DEX 7 INT - SPI 4 DEX Pen - Max Speed - Cost (c) 120

shrugs off scattered blows; only focused, concerted effort will bring one down. Their kind are rare and terrible, and seldom seen in numbers.

## Entry Structure

Each Monster entry is laid out in the order the Monster acts, so it can be read from top to bottom during play:

1. **Name and Role.** The Monster's name, with their battlefield Role in brackets.
2. **Description.** A short passage of lore and physical description, set in italics.
3. **Stat Line.** The table of HP, AV, SPD, LVL, CV, and Sz described above.
4. **AI Steps.** If the Monster has them, their numbered AI Steps appear here. When the Monster activates, they follow the Monster AI rules and attempt each AI Step in order. A step marked (on d6 N+) is attempted only if a d6 rolled for it shows N or higher.
5. **Attacks.** The Monster's attacks. If they have the Multi-Attack ability, that ability is listed first, since it governs how the attacks below it are made.
6. **Special Abilities.** The Monster's remaining abilities. Movement abilities, such as **Fly** or **Climb**, are always listed first.

Many Monsters share common abilities. A stat block may print their full rules or list them by name; **9.6 Universal Special Abilities** is authoritative.

## Greenmark Bestiary

### Giant Tarantula [Skirmisher]

*A hand-span of bristled legs around a body the size of a war helm, the giant tarantula stalks the Greenmark's leaf litter on stilted, deliberate steps. Its fangs weep a venom that turns a victim's muscles to wet rope. It spins no snares, preferring to run prey down and pin it where it falls. Foragers keep one eye on the canopy, because the largest specimens hunt from above and drop.*

| HP | AV | SPD | LVL | CV | Sz |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 9 | 0 | 6" | 1 | 1c | S |

**Attacks**

- **Bite:** 1d6 + 2 piercing damage.

**Special Abilities**

- **Small.**
- **Beast.**
- **Wallcrawler:** This Monster's listed **Speed** applies equally to vertical surfaces. They may move along walls and ceilings without spending additional movement for **Climb** and without making **STR Checks** to **Climb**. They cannot be knocked **Prone** while clinging to a vertical or overhanging surface.
- **Venom:** When this Monster's melee attack damages a target, that target must pass a **STR Check** or become **Poisoned [d4]**.
- **Standing Leap (6").**
- **Tremorsense (9").**

### Goblin [Minion]

*Knee-high, green-grey, and all elbows and malice, goblins infest the Greenmark's ruined steadings in chittering mobs. Each carries a notched blade and a sling of river stones, and not one will hold a line once the fight turns against it. Singly they are cowards; in numbers they are a tide. Greythorn's gatewardens read goblin-sign in the chewed bones left along the road.*

| HP | AV | SPD | LVL | CV | Sz |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 6 | 0 | 6" | 1 | 1c | S |

**Attacks**

- **Jagged Blade:** 1d4 slashing damage.
- **Short Sling: Ranged 8"**, 1d4 + 1 blunt damage.

**Special Abilities**

- **Small.**
- **Nimble:** After making an attack, they use **Shift 1"** toward the nearest **Cover Terrain**, avoiding hazards.
- **Darkvision (9").**

### Beastman [Minion]

*All fur and grievance, a beastman is a hunched man-shape topped with the head of a goat or boar, its hands ending in black claws. They run the forest edge in warbands, raiding for meat and metal, and there is nothing in them that will parley. They were among the first things the burning years shaped, and they have bred true down every generation since.*

**Scenario-Specific Monster: Great Forest Boar**

| HP | AV | SPD | LVL | CV | Sz |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| (5 × Party Size × (4 + (1 × APL))) / 8 | 1 + (APL/3, rounded down) | 7" | APL + 1 (min 3, max 7) | 0c | L |

**AI Steps**

**Target Priority:** Prioritize the valid enemy that most recently dealt damage to the Boar. If that enemy is not a valid target, use the normal Monster target priorities.

**Attacks**

- **Gore:** 1d10 + APL piercing damage.

**Special Abilities**

- **Ferocious Charge:** If the Boar moves at least 4" in a straight line before making a Gore attack in the same activation, that Gore deals an additional **1d6 damage of that attack's primary damage type**.
- **Trample:** At the start of their activation, if the Boar is not **Engaged** and has a **Primary Target**, they move up to their full Speed in a straight line toward that target, stopping at the last legal position. Every enemy whose space the Boar passes through suffers **1d8 + APL/2 blunt damage**. Each affected enemy makes a **DEX Check**; on a success, they suffer half of that damage. Each combatant that takes damage also falls **Prone**.
- **Enraged Bellow:** When the Boar is first reduced to 25% or less of their Max HP, at the start of their next activation they Bellow. All **Resting** Monster Groups on the battlefield immediately become **Awake**. During that activation, the Boar makes their Trample as normal, except the straight line's direction is determined by a **1d8** random-direction roll instead of the Boar's normal AI, and their Gore attack rolls its base damage dice with **Advantage**.
- **Thick Hide:** Reduce damage from ranged weapon attacks by 2, applied after **AV**.

**Boss Deployment:** Starts **Awake**, within **2"** of the Mud Wallow.

**Random Monster Setup:**

- **Group 1:** Roll once on the Greenmark Random Monster Table. Place within **4"** of a game trail, at least **10"** from the Mud Wallow. **Resting**.
- **Group 2:** Roll once on the Greenmark Random Monster Table. Place within a Thicket, at least **8"** from any Hero deployment zone. **Resting**.

**Party Deployment:** Parties deploy on opposite long battlefield edges, within **6"** of their edge.

**Special Rules:**

**Claiming the Pelt:** The Pristine Boar Pelt token is placed where the Boar fell when they are defeated. A Hero adjacent to the Pelt uses **Interact [1 AP]** to pick it up. It is a carried objective worth 5 × (2 + (4 × APL)) Coins if escaped with.

**Escape Conditions:** The Hero carrying the Pristine Boar Pelt must escape via any battlefield edge.

**Victory Conditions:** The adventure ends when the Pelt is carried off-map, after Round 8, or when all Heroes are defeated.

- The party whose Hero escapes with the Pelt wins and gains the Pelt's Coin Value.
- If the Pelt is not escaped with, the party that dealt the most total damage to the Boar gains a consolation prize of 3 × (2 + (4 × APL)) Coins. Tiebreaker: if both parties dealt identical total damage to the Boar, neither gains the consolation prize and both retain only their Chest and Monster CV totals.

Rewards from Treasure Chests and any Monster CV are added to each party's final total regardless of outcome.

**Tiebreaker:** If no party escapes with the Pelt and total Boar damage is also tied, the party with the most total Coin Value from all other sources wins.

### Scenario 2: The Whispering Grove

*The grove is older than Greythorn and older than the western forest road that skirts it. The standing stones hum when no wind passes, and pale lights move between them on moonless nights. Greythorn's farmers leave bread there and do not look back. Scholars call it a site of power. The Coun-*

you instead gain **Advantage** on the first **Setup Roll-off**, search, or scenario **Interact Check** made by your party during that adventure.

### 11.2.5 Hirelings

During the **Town Phase**, your party may recruit persistent **Hirelings** into its **Stronghold** roster. A Hireling remains on that roster until they are slain, dismissed during a **Town Phase**, or removed by a specific rule.

Hirelings are purchased with **Treasury** funds during the **Town Phase**. Recruiting a Hireling costs **1 TAP** and their listed coin cost.

Hirelings require no recurring upkeep once recruited. A party's **Stronghold** roster may contain no more than **8 Hirelings** total, including Animal Companions. A Hireling may be dismissed for no TAP cost during the Town Phase; a dismissed Hireling is removed permanently and grants no refund.

#### Active Hirelings and Summon Limits

At the start of each adventure, after choosing the Heroes who will take part in that adventure, choose which Hirelings from your **Stronghold** roster will deploy with that party.

The maximum number of active Hirelings for that adventure is determined by the number of Heroes in that party at the start of the adventure.

| Heroes in the Party | Maximum Active Hirelings | Per-Hero Control Limit |
|---:|---:|---:|
| **4** | **4** | **1** per Hero |
| **3** | **3** | **1** per Hero |
| **2** | **4** | **2** per Hero |
| **1** | **3** | **3** for that Hero |

These limits are checked only when the adventure begins. They do not recalculate later in that adventure if one or more Heroes are removed from play.

When you choose active Hirelings for an adventure, assign each active Hireling to a specific Hero in that party. That assignment is locked for the duration of the adventure.

A Hireling may only be assigned to a Hero whose printed **SPI** is equal to or greater than that Hireling's listed **Min SPI** value.

Use the Hero's printed **SPI** on their Hero sheet. Temporary in-adventure modifiers do not change which Hirelings that Hero may control.

Hirelings, including Animal Companions, do not count against the party-wide limit of **2** active allied Summons. See **2.5.1 Summon Limits**.

#### Specialist Hireling Roster

These are trained mortal retainers recruited into the party's **Stronghold** roster.

**Porter**
**Min SPI** 2 **Cost** 12c **SPD** 6" **Sz** M **HP** 6 **AV** 0
**Attack** None
**Special Abilities:** Cannot attack. May use **Interact** to pick up, carry, transfer, drop, and extract one treasure chest, relic, or other bulky objective as though they were a **Hero**. This permission does not allow them to control or score any other objective. **Drag [1 AP]:** Move one adjacent **Knocked Out** Hero **2"**.

**Torchbearer**
**Min SPI** 2 **Cost** 16c **SPD** 6" **Sz** M **HP** 5 **AV** 0
**Attack** None
**Special Abilities:** Counts as a **Light Source** while on the battlefield.

**Squire**
**Min SPI** 3 **Cost** 32c **SPD** 6" **Sz** M **HP** 10 **AV** 1
**Attack** **Shortsword: 1d6 slashing damage**
**Special Abilities:** **Assist:** While adjacent to a Hero, that Hero gains **+1 AV**.

**Sellsword**
**Min SPI** 4 **Cost** 40c **SPD** 6" **Sz** M **HP** 8 **AV** 1
**Attack** **Shortsword: 1d6 slashing damage**
**Special Abilities:** **Round Shield:** Gain **d6 AD** when using **Block**.

**Apothecary**
**Min SPI** 4 **Cost** 44c **SPD** 6" **Sz** M **HP** 7 **AV** 0
**Attack** None
**Special Abilities:** **Remedy [2 AP]:** One adjacent Hero regains **2 HP** and removes **Poisoned [dX]**.

**Archer**
**Min SPI** 4 **Cost** 48c **SPD** 7" **Sz** M **HP** 7 **AV** 0
**Attack** **Shortbow: 1d6 piercing damage, 16"**
**Special Abilities:** **Steady Shot:** The first ranged attack this Hireling resolves each round ignores **Cover**.

## C.5 Reactions Summary

A **Reaction** is an action taken when a rule's stated trigger occurs, usually outside the reacting combatant's activation. A combatant may take a **Reaction** during their own activation if its trigger occurs then. Taking a **Reaction** does not begin or end an activation. To take a **Reaction**, a combatant must have enough unspent AP to pay their cost. **Heroes** and **Hirelings** may use **Reactions** unless a rule says otherwise. Allied **Summons** may use **Reactions** only if a rule explicitly grants that **Summon Reactions**. **Monsters** do not take **Reactions** unless a rule explicitly allows them. A combatant may take multiple **Reactions** in the same round if they have enough unspent AP and a legal trigger, but may take only one **Reaction** in response to the same action or effect. For each affected combatant, only 1 Reaction may be declared by that combatant or on their behalf to modify how the source resolves against them; if 2 or more would do so, the affected combatant's controller chooses which one is declared, and the others spend no costs. A Reaction used by the source's controller to modify the source's own roll does not count against an affected combatant's limit. A Reaction resolves immediately when declared unless its rule or a resolution sequence assigns a later timing. A Reaction that grants a separate action still uses the reacting combatant's one-Reaction limit, but does not prevent a different combatant from reacting unless both Reactions would modify the source against the same affected combatant. If no rule grants an allied **Summon Reactions**, their unspent AP cannot be spent on **Reactions** and is discarded at the end of the round.

| Reaction | AP Cost | Trigger | Effect |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Block** | [1 AP] | An attack or effect would deal **blunt**, **piercing**, or **slashing** damage to you while you have an equipped shield and can take **Reactions**. | Roll your shield's **AD**, if any, and add its flat **AV** to the **AV** you already apply against that source. |

# Index

*Main entries follow the terms of C.11 Glossary of Terms and Conditions. Locators point to the glossary entry, the sections it cites, and sections that define or apply the term.*


## A

**Acid**, 409
**Active Party**, 348, 409
**Adamantine**, 91, 409
**Adjacent**, 409
**Advantage**, 13, 92, 409
**Adventure Preparation**, 253
**Aftermath**. *See* Aftermath Phase
**Aftermath Phase**, 352, 408, 409
**AI Step**, 184, 410, 420
**Allied**, 338, 410
**Ally**, 410
**Ancestries**
- Deep Elf, 65
- Demonborn, 65
- Drakeblood, 65
- Dwarf, 63
- Elf, 63
- Gnome, 64
- Goblin, 64
- Halfling, 63
- Human, 63
- Orc, 64
- Ratkin, 64

**AP**, 10, 31, 35, 36, 83, 410
**APL**, 85, 92, 93, 343, 410
**Arcane**, 120, 121, 122, 410
**Area of Effect**, 18, 410
**Armour**, 98
**Armour Dice (AD)**, 49, 410
**Armour Value (AV)**, 49, 410
**Attack Sequence**, 46, 405
**Aura**, 14, 18, 410
**Awake**, 180, 182, 344, 410

## B

**Backgrounds**, 65
**Base Damage Dice**, 410
**Basic Mode**, 385
**Beast**, 186, 190, 192, 410
**Bench**, 348, 410
**Bleeding**, 54, 410
**Blinded**, 54, 410
**Block**, 49, 410
**Blocking Terrain**, 23, 411
**Blood Price**, 163, 411
**Blood Surge**, 82, 411
**Blunt**, 406, 411
**Boss**, 411
**Boss Scale**, 189, 411
**Burning**, 54, 411

## C

**Campaign Cycle**, 352
**Carried Objective**, 411
**Caster Supremacy**, 72, 411
**Casting Check**, 411
**Celestial**, 411
**Character Creation**, 59
**Check**, 12, 411
**Classes**
- Assassin, 75
- Berserker, 74
- Cleric, 77
- Druid, 83
- Fighter, 73
- Paladin, 78
- Psion, 80
- Ranger, 76
- Rogue, 74
- Sorcerer, 82
- Trickster, 81
- Wizard, 79

**Climb**, 41, 411
**Coin Value**, 411
**Coins**, 411
**Collision**, 40, 411
**Combatant**, 30, 411
**Cover**, 20, 21, 411, 420
**Cover Terrain**, 17, 23, 412
**Critical Cast**, 147, 152, 412
**Critical Failure**, 412
**Critical Hit**, 47, 139, 412
**Critical Success**, 412
**Cursed**, 54, 327, 412

## D

**Dangerous Terrain**, 25, 412, 424
**Darkness**, 21, 412, 425
**Darkvision**, 62, 412
**Declared State**, 16, 412
**Deep Water**, 25, 412, 425
**DEX Check**, 412
**DEX Pen**, 98, 412
**Difficult Terrain**, 25, 41, 412
**Disadvantage**, 13, 412
**Dodge**, 46, 49, 412

## E

**Elevation**, 26, 412, 425
**Empower**, 147, 149, 150, 413
**End of Round**, 32
**Enemy**, 413
**Engaged**, 183, 413
**Explosion**, 18, 413
**Extract**, 413

## F

**Falling**, 42, 413
**Fiend**, 187, 213, 215, 413
**Finesse**, 94, 387, 388, 390, 413
**Fire**, 413
**Footprint**, 14, 413
**Forced Movement**, 40, 413
**Frightened**, 54, 413

## G

**General Talents**, 69
**Guard Point**, 413

## H

**Heal / Healing**, 413
**Heard the Song**, 189, 233, 413
**Hero**, 52, 59, 60, 413
**Hero Advancement**, 86
**Hidden**, 17, 18, 20, 23, 54, 55, 413
**Hireling**, 413
**Hirelings**, 86
**Holy**, 413
**HP**, 48, 52, 83, 179, 386, 413
**HP loss**, 48, 414
**Huge (H)**, 413